

VICTIM OR VICTOR

Blue denotes power point slide

Brown denotes instructions to technician

TEXT: Psalm 10:1-18 (CEV) *"Why are you far away, LORD? Why do you hide yourself when I am in trouble? ²Proud and brutal people hunt down the poor. But let them get caught by their own evil plans! ³The wicked brag about their deepest desires. Those greedy people hate and curse you, LORD. ⁴The wicked are too proud to turn to you or even think about you. ⁵They are always successful, though they can't understand your teachings, and they keep sneering at their enemies. ⁶In their hearts they say, "Nothing can hurt us! We'll always be happy and free from trouble." ⁷They curse and tell lies, and all they talk about is how to be cruel or how to do wrong. ⁸They hide outside villages, waiting to strike and murder some innocent victim. ⁹They are hungry lions hiding in the bushes, hoping to catch some helpless passerby. They trap the poor in nets and drag them away. ¹⁰They crouch down and wait to grab a victim. ¹¹They say, "God can't see! He's got on a blindfold." ¹²Do something, LORD God, and use your powerful arm to help those in need. ¹³The*

wicked don't respect you. In their hearts they say, "God won't punish us!" ¹⁴But you see the trouble and the distress, and you will do something. The poor can count on you, and so can orphans. ¹⁵Now break the arms of all merciless people. Punish them for doing wrong and make them stop. ¹⁶Our LORD, you will always rule, but nations will vanish from the earth. ¹⁷You listen to the longings of those who suffer. You offer them hope, and you pay attention to their cries for help. ¹⁸You defend orphans and everyone else in need, so that no one on earth can terrify others again."

INTRO: This world is full of: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Takers and givers...
- Have's and have not's...
- Hunters and the hunted...
- Pursuers and the pursued...
- Wrongdoer and victims...

According to the Uniform Crime Report in 2009:

- 1,318,398 violent crimes occurred nationwide, one violent crime every 24 seconds...

- 15,241 murders, one murder every 35 minutes...
- 88,097 forcible rapes, one forcible rape every 6 seconds...
- 408,297 robberies, one robbery every 1.5 minutes...

If every crime has only one victim this means there were 1,830,033 in 2009. That calculates to one in every 164 people were victimized by crime in this country in 2009. All of us know that if a family member is victimized it affects the entire family and circle of friends. We are becoming a nation of victims.

By definition a victim is: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- A person who has been hurt or killed...
- A person who has been duped...
- A helpless person...

Applying that definition, is there anyone present today who does not feel that they have been victimized at some point?

In our text the Psalmist lays out a scenario that describes in vivid detail, the victimization of the righteous.

I. QUESTIONS AND STATEMENTS OF A VICTIM...

In the first half of this chapter the Psalmist asks questions and makes some statements that lead us to believe he has been or feels victimized:

- Why are you so far away Lord?
- Why do you hide from me when I am in trouble?
- The proud and brutal hunt down the poor!
- The greedy hate God!
- The wicked are too arrogant to think about the Lord or even regard him!
- The wicked are always successful therefore they know nothing about the teaching of God!
- The wicked look at their subjects arrogantly!
- The wicked say in their hearts, nothing can go wrong for us; we will always be successful!
- Their speech is always full of cursing and lying!
- They are always looking for another victim!

David Emerald said, *“Every Victim requires a Persecutor. But the Persecutor isn’t always*

necessarily a person. The Persecutor could also be a condition or a circumstance. A persecuting condition might be a disease or a heart attack, or an injury. A persecuting circumstance could be a natural disaster, like a hurricane or an earthquake or a house burning down.”

David compares the persecutors to: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Predators lying in wait to pounce on an unsuspecting victim!
- Hungry lions hiding in the bushes waiting to devour the helpless prey!
- Fishermen hauling in the defenseless fish for a seaside fish fry!
- Robbers crouching down and hiding out to use the element of surprise against their victims!

Notice what the Psalmist declares the statements of the wicked to be:

- God can't see!
- God is wearing a blindfold!
- God deserves no respect!
- God won't punish us!

The bottom line here is that the Psalmist feels he is the victim about to be pulled under for the

last time by the undertow of adversity! Have you ever felt that way? Are you there right now?

David appears to have lost touch with reality and is drowning in the despair of dashed dreams and a broken heart. For David, reality is that he does not honestly know whether there will be a recovery. Does that sound familiar?

II. VICTIMS ALWAYS TEND TO BE PESSEMISTIC...

Here in Psalm ten, David is not just laying out a complaint against the wicked; he seems to be questioning whether God will defend his own honor. One of the most painful hurts in the world is when one has lived uprightly, followed the instructions of the Bible and honored God and everyone else, yet, the wrongdoer's prosper! How does one rectify that in their mind and spirit? This is exactly where David was at, and quite frankly the lack of answers were about to render him a victim!

David feels absolutely helpless in:

- Dealing with his adversaries...
- Watching the wicked prosper...
- Feeling that God was doing nothing...

John W. Gardner said, *“Self-pity is easily the most destructive of the non-pharmaceutical narcotics; it is addictive, gives momentary pleasure and separates the victim from reality.”*
(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)

Notice David’s advice to God:

- Get up and do something...
- Raise your hand to the enemy...
- Entrap the enemy in his own plan...
- Use your power to help those in need...
- Break the arm of the merciless...
- Punish them until they stop...

It is quite understandable that when one has been victimized, they tend to be pessimistic; the injury causes one to shut down and go into a defensive mode.

In Psalm ten this is exactly where David seems to be, he feels absolutely defenseless against such powerful, well trained, resourceful adversaries. *When a person allows themselves to slip into a victim mentality they:* **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Shut down emotionally and spiritually...

- They shut family, friends and acquaintances out...
- They go into a defense mode, striking out at everyone around them...

This is a critical time. It is at this stage where one must decide whether to be ruled by the unfortunate incident or fight back? Are we going to be pessimistic or optimistic?

III. VICTIMS TRANSITIONING TO VICTORS...

There is nothing wrong with expressing pain, which is what David spent the first thirteen verses doing.

Medical science say's a grieving process is normal and healthy. The expression of pain and allowing our emotions to run their course serve as a shock absorber to the organs and systems of the human body. Some grief and emotional outbursts are beneficial but we cannot allow ourselves to be ruled by our emotions.

There comes a time when one must decide they have had enough of living in the role of a victim and get up and allow God the opportunity to turn the tables on the enemy. **Victims can become victors! (LEAVE ON SCREEN**

UNTIL NEXT SLIDE) Victims are those who have been beaten down and destroyed but victors are by definition, winners!

Suddenly in verse fourteen David cries out to the Lord in a new and faith-filled way. ***“You see the trouble and the distress, and you will do something. The poor can count on you, and so can orphans.”***

David is about to be catapulted from the ranks of the victimization to the high-flying ways of a winner! Look at David makes the journey from defeat to victory: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- His faith began to push back against doubt...
- His confidence began to awaken to hopefulness...
- His knowing began to argue with his feelings...

The struggle between emotion and faith is as follows:

- Emotions say, *“I do not feel redeemed.”* – Faith say’s, *“I am as righteous as the blood of Jesus can make me.”*

- Emotions say, *“I do not feel the Spirit living within.”* – Faith say’s, *“Walk in the Spirit and you will be victorious.”*
- Emotions say, *“I do not feel well.”* – Faith say’s, *“By His stripes I am healed.”*
- Emotions say, *“I am defeated.”* – Faith say’s *“I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength.”*

Listen to David’s declaration of faith in the face of adversity:

- You will do something...
- The poor can count on you...
- The orphans will find protection in you...
- You will break the arms of the merciless...
- You will severely punish wrongdoers...
- Nations come and go but you remain enthroned...
- You listen intently to the cry of those who are suffering...
- You are the one who can offer hope in hopeless situations...
- Because of you no bully can ever make the righteous a victim...

Vince Lombardi said, *“I firmly believe that any man’s finest hour, the greatest fulfillment of all*

that he holds dear, is the moment that he has worked his heart out in a good cause and lies exhausted on the field of battle – victorious.”
(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)

CONCLUSION:

When one has been victimized there are rarely quick answers or deliverances. The real test is whether one can stay afloat long enough to outlast the questions, doubts, hopelessness and emotions. Hebrews 11:1 (CEV) *“Faith makes us sure of what we hope for and gives us proof of what we cannot see.”* Hebrews 11:6 (NKJV) *“But without faith it is impossible to please Him, for he who comes to God must believe that He is, and that He is a rewarder of those who diligently seek Him.”*

We do not have to live the victimized life; we can be victorious through Christ! Romans 8:37-39 (NKJV) *“In all these things we are more than conquerors through Him who loved us.”* ³⁸ *For I am persuaded that neither death nor life, nor angels nor principalities nor powers, nor things present nor things to come,* ³⁹ *nor height nor depth, nor any other created thing, shall be able to separate us from the*

love of God which is in Christ Jesus our Lord.”

Take-a-way Scriptures: **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE END OF THE SERVICE)**

- Hebrews 11:1
- Hebrews 11:6
- Romans 8:37-39